White Chicken Chili

Soups | Instant Pot

Before you start

Use a 6-quart or larger Instant Pot and 1 3/4 lb raw, thawed boneless, skinless chicken breasts. High Pressure: 10 minutes; natural release: 10 minutes. Allow about 45-55 minutes total, including coming to pressure. Add beans and corn after pressure cooking; add dairy off the heat.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Onion and jalapeño

Bowl B - Garlic, oregano, and cumin

Bowl C - Broth and green chiles

Bowl D - White beans and corn; add after pressure cooking

- [ ] 1 tbsp. neutral oil
- [ ] 1 medium yellow onion, chopped [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 jalapeño, seeded, finely chopped [Bowl A]
- [ ] 2 cloves garlic, finely chopped [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp. dried oregano [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp. ground cumin [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 3/4 lb raw boneless, skinless chicken breasts, thawed; cut very large breasts in half crosswise
- [ ] 5 cups low-sodium chicken broth [Bowl C]
- [ ] 2 (4.5-oz.) cans green chiles [Bowl C]
- [ ] Kosher salt, to taste

- [ ] Freshly ground black pepper, to taste
- [ ] 2 (15-oz.) cans white beans, drained, rinsed [Bowl D]
- [ ] 8 oz. shredded Monterey Jack
- [ ] 8 oz cream cheese, softened and cut into small cubes
- [ ] 1 1/2 c. frozen corn [Bowl D]
- [ ] 1/2 c. sour cream
- [ ] 1 avocado, thinly sliced, for serving
- [ ] 1/4 c. chopped fresh cilantro, for serving
- [ ] 1/4 c. crushed tortilla chips, for serving

1. Sauté the aromatics

1. Select Sauté and heat 1 tbsp neutral oil. Add 1 chopped medium yellow onion and 1 seeded, finely chopped jalapeño. Cook 5-7 minutes, stirring, until softened.

2. Add 2 finely chopped garlic cloves, 1 tsp dried oregano, and 1 tsp ground cumin. Cook about 30-60 seconds, stirring, until fragrant.

2. Pressure-cook the chicken

1. Pour in 5 cups low-sodium chicken broth and add two 4 1/2 oz cans green chiles. Scrape the bottom thoroughly until no browned bits remain. Press Cancel.

2. Nestle 1 3/4 lb raw, thawed boneless, skinless chicken breasts into the broth. Cut very large breasts in half crosswise first. Season with kosher salt and black pepper to taste. Leave the beans, corn, cream cheese, sour cream, and Monterey Jack out for now.

3. Seal the lid and set High Pressure for 10 minutes. When cooking ends, let pressure release naturally for 10 minutes, then carefully release the remaining pressure.

4. Open the lid and check that the thickest part of the chicken reaches 165°F. If needed, use Sauté to simmer it in the broth until it does. Transfer the cooked chicken to a bowl and shred with two forks.

3. Add the beans and finish

1. Select Sauté on Low. Stir in two 15 oz cans drained and rinsed white beans and 1 1/2 cups frozen corn. Simmer gently about 5 minutes, until hot. Mash roughly one-quarter of the beans against the side of the pot to thicken the broth. For a thicker chili, simmer uncovered a few more minutes before adding dairy.

2. Press Cancel. Put 8 oz softened, cubed cream cheese in a bowl. Gradually whisk in about 1 cup hot broth ladled from the pot until smooth, then stir the mixture back into the chili.

3. Return all the shredded chicken to the pot and stir in 1/2 cup sour cream. Warm gently if necessary without boiling. Taste and adjust kosher salt and black pepper.

4. Ladle into bowls. Divide 8 oz shredded Monterey Jack, 1 thinly sliced avocado, 1/4 cup chopped cilantro, and 1/4 cup crushed tortilla chips among the servings, as desired.

Notes

Instant Pot adaptation of your saved White Chicken Chili, using the updated 1 3/4 lb chicken-breast amount from your Google Doc. This version cooks raw boneless, skinless breasts directly in the pot; no separate sous-vide cooking is needed.

The original 5 cups broth and all other ingredient amounts are retained. This makes a looser chili; mash some beans and simmer uncovered before adding dairy for more body.

Cream cheese now has an explicit addition step: soften, whisk with hot broth, and stir in after pressure cooking. Add sour cream off the heat; Monterey Jack remains a serving topping.

Timing assumes thawed chicken; it is not a frozen-chicken or bone-in-chicken schedule.

Adaptation references: https://www.deliciousmeetshealthy.com/instant-pot-white-chicken-chili/ (10-minute pressure cook and cream-cheese finish); https://instantpot.com/blogs/recipes/creamy-white-chicken-chili (sauté/deglaze workflow, 10-minute natural release, and dairy after pressure cooking).